

"Never Alone"

Characters:

- Ethan (a discouraged young man)
 - Grandpa
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Ethan: (*frustrated*)

Grandpa... can I ask you something?

Grandpa: (*calmly*)

You can ask me anything, son.

Ethan:

Why does it feel like God is so far away?

Grandpa: (*gently*)

What makes you feel that way?

Ethan: (*emotionally*)

Everything keeps going wrong.

I studied hard and still failed my exam.

My friends seem to have everything figured out.

And every time I pray, it feels like my words just disappear into the air.

Sometimes... I wonder if God even hears me.

Grandpa: *(after a pause)*

Ethan, let me tell you a story.

A man once dreamed that he was walking along a beach with God.

As they walked, two sets of footprints stretched across the sand.

One belonged to the man.

The other belonged to God.

Ethan: *(curious)*

Two sets of footprints?

Grandpa:

That's right.

But when the man looked back over the hardest moments of his life—

the moments of fear, pain and feeling completely alone—

he noticed something strange.

There was only one set of footprints.

Ethan: *(quietly)*

Only one?

Grandpa:

Only one.

The man became upset.

He turned to God and asked,

"Lord, You promised You would always be with me. Why did You leave me during the times I needed You most?"

Ethan: *(leaning forward)*

What did God say?

Grandpa: *(warmly)*

God answered,

"My child, I love you too much to leave you. During those difficult times, when you saw only one set of footprints, it was then that I carried you."

Ethan: *(softly)*

Carried him...

Grandpa:

Yes.

You see, Ethan, when life is easy, God often walks beside us.

But when life becomes too heavy—

when the burden is too much—

He doesn't abandon us.

He carries us.

Ethan: *(reflective)*

So even when I feel alone...

I'm not?

Grandpa: *(firmly)*

No.

Not for a second.

Not when you're celebrating.

Not when you're struggling.

Not when you're confused.

And certainly not when you're hurting.

Ethan: *(voice growing stronger)*

Then maybe God hasn't been silent.

Maybe He's been helping me all along.

Grandpa: *(smiling)*

Exactly.

Sometimes we expect God to remove the storm.

But often, He chooses to walk with us through it.

Ethan: *(with renewed confidence)*

I think I understand now.

The hard times weren't proof that God had left me.

They were proof that I needed Him most.

Grandpa: *(proudly)*

And He was right there beside you.

Or carrying you.

Ethan: *(strongly)*

Then no matter what comes next...

I'll keep trusting Him.

Grandpa: *(warmly)*

That's faith, son.

That's faith.

Together: *(slowly and confidently)*

"I will never leave thee, nor forsake thee."

— **Hebrews 13:5**

End